🥣 Meal 8 – Warming Lentil & Sweet Potato Stew

🌱 Earthy | Nourishing | One-pot meal

📋 MENU (for 35 people)

Main: Lentil and sweet potato stew with carrots, kale, and warming spices

Grain: Steamed white rice with bay leaves

⏱️ TOTAL PREP TIME: 1h 45

Team size: 4–5 people

Cooking Method: Big pot for stew + big pot for rice

Tools: Cutting boards, knives, big pot, stirring spoon, bowls

🛒 INGREDIENT LIST (35 servings)

🍲 Lentil Stew

- • Dry lentils: 1.3 kg (or ~3.5 kg cooked)
- • Sweet potatoes (cubed): 3 kg
- • Carrots (sliced): 2.5 kg
- • Onions (diced): 1.2 kg
- • Garlic (minced): 6 cloves
- • Kale (chopped): 1.2 kg
- • Olive oil: 200 ml
- • Cumin powder: 2 tbsp
- • Coriander powder: 1 tbsp
- • Turmeric: 1 tbsp
- • Salt: 2 tbsp
- • Black pepper: 1 tbsp
- • Bay leaves: 3
- • Water: ~9 liters (pre-boiled)

🍚 Rice

- • White rice: 3.5 kg
- • Pre-boiled water: ~7 liters
- • Salt: 1.5 tbsp
- • Olive oil: 100 ml
- • Bay leaves: 4

👨‍🍳 TEAM TASKS BREAKDOWN

Group 1 – Stew Prep Team

- • Dice onions, mince garlic
- • Peel and cube sweet potatoes, slice carrots
- • Sauté onions and garlic, then add spices
- • Add lentils, veg, water, salt, bay leaves
- • Simmer until tender (~40 min), stir often
- • Add chopped kale at the end, cook ~5–10 min

Group 2 – Rice Team

- • Rinse rice well
- • Add to big pot with water, salt, bay leaves, oil
- • Cook until soft, fluff before serving

🕒 SUGGESTED TIME PLAN (1h 45 total)

00:00–00:15 — Assign tasks, prep workspace

00:15–00:40 — Chop vegetables & measure spices

00:40–01:10 — Sauté aromatics & build stew base

00:30–01:00 — Start rice preparation and cooking

01:00–01:30 — Simmer stew, adjust seasoning

01:30–01:45 — Final touches, cleanup, serve buffet-style

✅ NOTES

- • Pre-soak lentils for faster cooking (optional).
- • Keep stirring stew to avoid burning bottom.
- • Add kale only at the end to preserve color and texture.